

Earth and space science

The Earth is a dot in a vast universe filled with planets and moons, stars and galaxies. As far as we know, the Earth is special because it is the only place that supports life. Earth and space science is the study of the structure of our planet—and everything that exists beyond it.



Volcanology is the scientific study of volcanoes.



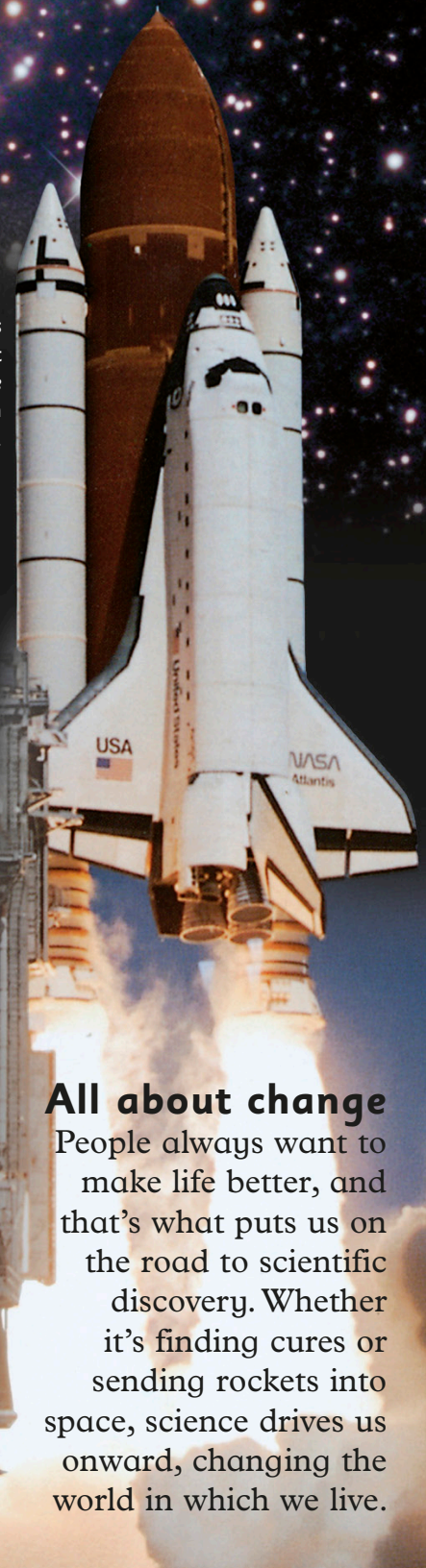
One branch of science studies how materials can change.

Materials science

Our universe is filled with atoms and molecules, which make up elements, compounds, and mixtures. Materials science is the study of these things, how they behave, how we use them, and how they react with one another.

Pictures of the Earth from space help scientists understand the Earth better.

This is NASA's Atlantis orbiter—part of its Space Shuttle program, which ended in 2011.



All about change

People always want to make life better, and that's what puts us on the road to scientific discovery. Whether it's finding cures or sending rockets into space, science drives us onward, changing the world in which we live.